Y-N-711F
December 21, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. Y-N-00711E (Army-GL)
March 30, 1973 and
Fed. Spec. Y-N-711c
August 12, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

NUTS (UNSHELLED), ASSORTED OR MIXED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for kinds, (species), types or varieties, sizes and grades of unshelled nuts, for all Federal agencies.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Mixture. Mixed nuts shall be of the following mixes as specified (see 6.1).

Mix No. 1 (see 3.4)
Mix No. 2 (see 3.4)

1.2.2 Sizes. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the nuts shall be of the following sizes as defined in the applicable United States Standards and as specified in 3.3.

English Walnuts:
  Large
  Medium
Pecans:
  Large
  Medium
Almonds:
Filberts:
  Large round-type
  Medium round-type
  Large long-type
  Medium long-type
Brazil Nuts:
  Large
  Medium

FSC 8925

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

UU-S-48 - Sacks, Shipping, Paper

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-668 - Sanitary Standards for Food Plants

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activign or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U. S. Department of Health, Education, and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Douments, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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U. S. Department of Agriculture

United States Standards for Grades of Walnuts in the Shell
United States Standards for Pecans in the Shell
United States Standards for Grades of Almonds in the Shell
United States Standards for Grades of Filberts in the Shell
United States Standards for Grades of Brazil Nuts in the Shell
United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Bejamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20044.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Nuts. The nuts shall be of the following kinds (species): English Walnuts, Filberts, Pecans, Brazil Nuts and Almonds. Varieties shall be as specified in 3.1 through 3.1.5.

3.1.1 English walnuts. English walnuts shall be limited to the following varieties: "Budded" including the Placentia Perfection and like varieties, Concord, Eureka, Franquette, Mayette or Payne.

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3.1.2 Pecans. Pecans shall be limited to the following varieties: Schley, Van Deman, Stuart, Burkett, Moneymaker, Pabst, and Success.

3.1.3 Almonds. Almonds shall be limited to the following varieties: Nonpareil, Drake, Ne-Plus, I.X.L., Peerless and Mission.

3.1.4 Filberts. Filberts shall be limited to the following varieties: Barcelona and similar round-type varieties, DuChilly and similar long type varieties.

3.1.5 Brazil nuts. Brazil nuts shall be of recognized commercial varieties.

3.2 Description of grades. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the grade shall be of No. 1 grade and shall be in accordance with the current United States Standards for Walnuts in the Shell, United States Standards for Pecans in the Shell, United States Standards for Filberts in the Shell, United States Standards for Almonds in the Shell, and United States Standards for Brazil Nuts in the Shell, respectively, except that mixed nuts shall comply with requirements specified in 3.4.

3.3 Description of sizes. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the size requirements for all unshelled nuts, except almonds and Brazil nuts, shall be in accordance with the applicable United States Standard. Size of unshelled almonds and Brazil nuts shall be as specified in 3.3.1 and 3.3.2, respectively.

3.3.1 Almonds. The thickness shall be not less than indicated below for the following varieties:

	Inch	(mm)
Mission	28/64	(11.1)
Nonpareil	30/64	(11.9)
Ne-Plus	32/64	(12.7)
I.X.L.	34/64	(13.5)
Peerless	36/64	(14.3)
Drake	36/64	(14.3)

3.3.2 Brazil nuts. The count shall be 46 to 62 nuts to the pound.

3.4 Mixed nuts. Mixed nuts shall be a uniform mixture of unshelled nuts which meet the requirements covering the kinds, varieties, sizes, and grade specified, except that English walnuts and pecans need not be fairly uniform in color of shells. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), mixed nuts shall contain a mixture by weight as follows:

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	Percent by weight	
	Mix No. 1	Mix No. 2
English Walnuts	35 ± 3.5	None
Pecans	20 ± 2.5	31 ± 3.1
Almonds	15 ± 2.5	22 ± 2.2
Filberts	10 ± 2.0	16 ± 1.6
Brazil Nuts	20 ± 3.5	31 ± 3.1

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.6 Workmanship. The product shall be prepared in accordance with part 128 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Title 21, Human Foods; Current Good Manufacturing Practices (Sanitation) in Manufacturing, Processing, Packing or Holding. For Military agencies, the product shall be processed in establishments meeting the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirement as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Pre-acceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 For Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.2 For Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.6.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by the U. S. Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the Military, see 4.3.4).

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4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.3 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and material shall be inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.3.1 Identity of nuts. Conformance of each kind of nuts to requirement for type, variety, grade and size, as applicable, shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent USDA certificates or other valid documentation. In the event such certification is not tendered or reflects data that is not in conformance to requirements, the nuts shall not be acceptable and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.3.3.2 Primary bags. Conformance to 5.1.1 as concerns bag material shall be ascertained by examination of pertinent invoices, label, or other valid documents. Use of nonconforming bags shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.3.4 Examination of end item. Examination of end item shall be in accordance with tables II through IV, 4.3.4.1 and 4.3.4.2. Sampling plans shall be in accordance with table I. The acceptable quality levels (AQLs) shall be expressed as percent defective for tables II and III and defects per hundred units for table IV.

TABLE I. Sampling plans

Table	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	AQLs	
				Major	Minor
II	One filled primary container	Primary container	S-3	-	2.5
III	One filled primary container	Primary container	S-2	-	4.0
IV	One filled and closed level C shipping container	Shipping container	S-3	2.5	-

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TABLE II. Examination of net weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Less than required net weight

1/ Weighing device shall be calibrated in increments of not more than 1 ounce (gram).

TABLE III. Examination of mixture 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Percentage by weight of each kind of nut not as required by 3.4 or as otherwise specified

1/ The following procedure for sampling shall apply to nuts in 50 pound (22.7 kg) bags: Lay the bag on a flat surface and constrict the center with a cord or strap. Remove the contents from one end only, for each sample unit. Alternate ends for the entire sample size.

TABLE IV. Examination of level C shipping container

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Insecure closure, open seam, tear or hole through container
102	Markings missing, incorrect or illegible

4.3.4.1 Examination of primary conatiner. Examination of primary container (other than shipping containers), for condition and labeling (when required), shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

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4.3.4.2 Examination of level A shipping sack. Level A, multiwall paper shipping sacks shall be in accordance with the applicable quality assurance provisions in the appendix of UU-S-48. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the examination: Required contractural markings missing, incorrect or illegible. Tear, hole, open seam or broken stitches.

4.4 Test methods. Test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum, such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.4.1 Test procedures.

4.4.1.1 Chemical analyses. Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required (see 6.1) by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists in effect on date of invitation for bids, or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or level C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Fifty pounds (22.7 kg) of nuts shall be packed in a cloth bag. Cloth bags shall be strong, new, well-sewn sacks of standard Calcutta burlap, weighing not less than 10 ounces per linear yard (283 g per meter) when 40 inches (102 cm) wide, or of unbleached Osnaburg cotton of the grade of material indicated by the marking 36 (38 or 40 sley by 24 to 26 pick), 2.35 yards per pound (2.15 m per 0.45 kg) or pro rata widths. The closures shall be sewn in accordance with accepted commercial practice. Thread sizes shall be 4/10 cotton thread in the needle and 4/12 cotton thread in the looper, using not less than 3-1/2 stitches to the inch (25 mm).

5.1.2 Level C. Unless otherwise specified, commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1 or 5.2.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. One 50 pound (22.7 kg) cloth bag of the product shall be packed in a multiwall paper shipping sack constructed and sealed in accordance with type I or II, style A or B, construction 8 or 8X of UU-S-48.

5.2.2 Level C. The shipping container shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

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5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Labeling. Any commercial labeling or additional labeling, as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder, shall be acceptable.

5.3.1.2 Marking for shipment. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Labeling. Labeling in accordance with 5.3.1.1 shall be acceptable.

5.3.2.2 Marking of shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options specified herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size and mixture required (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).
(c) When other than No. 1 grade is desired (see 3.2).
(d) Size and thickness required if other than specified (see 3.3).
(e) Applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When other than specified mixture by weight and variety of mix is desired (see 3.4).
(g) When plant sanitation inspection is required for civil agencies (see 4.2.1).
(h) When chemical analysis is required (see 4.4.1.1).

6.2 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.3 Destination inspection (civil agencies). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

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6.4 Military agencies. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15, NAVSUPINST 4030.28, AFR 71-6, MCO 4030.14D or DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

Military Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA - DMS
HEW - FDA, NIH
AGR - AMS
GSA - FSS

Project No. 8925-0098

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